In association with NPTEL

Schedule for the Two Day International Conference

Empowering Humanities and Social Sciences:
A Discourse on Nation Building and Sustainability

Department of Humanities and Social Sciences, IIT Roorkee

9th and 10th of October, 2026



Day 1: 09.10.2026

TIME	PARTICULARS	VENUE
08:00 AM - 09:00 AM	*Breakfast*	Khosla International House (KIH)
09:00 AM - 10:00 AM	Registration of Participants	1st Floor HSS Department
10:00 AM	Welcoming the Guests and Participants	Auditorium (H-601) HSS Department
10:01 AM	Felicitation of the Guests	
10:05 AM	Lamp Lighting	
10:08 AM	National Song followed by Kulgeet	
10:10 AM	Inaugural Address by the Convener/HoD **Prof Smita Jha**	
10:20 AM	Deputy Director's Address **Prof Praveen Kumar** **IIT Roorkee**	
10:25 AM	Introduction to the Keynote Speaker and their Address **Prof Sangit K Ragi** **Delhi University**	
11:00 AM - 11:30 AM	*High Tea*	6th Floor HSS Department
11:30 AM - 12:15 PM	Plenary Lecture - I **Dr Avishek Parui** **IIT Madras**	Auditorium (H-601) HSS Department
12:15 PM - 01:00 PM	Plenary Lecture - II **Prof Ralph Pite** **University of Bristol**	
01:00 PM - 02:15 PM	*Lunch*	Khosla International House (KIH)
02:15 PM - 03:00 PM	Plenary Lecture - III **Prof G N Jha** **Jawaharlal Nehru University**	Auditorium (H-601) HSS Department

03:00 PM - 04:15 PM	Panel Session - I	
04:15 PM - 04:45 PM	*Tea Break*	6th Floor HSS Department
04:45 PM - 05:45 PM	Panel Session - II	
07:30 PM	Gala Dinner	6th Floor HSS Department

Panel Session I: 3 PM to 4.15 PM

Panel 1: Knowledge and the Project of Nation-Building

Venue: H-201 (Visitor's Lounge)

Chair: Prof Binod Mishra (Professor, IIT Roorkee)

Moderator: Naitik

- Beyond STEM: Humanising India's Knowledge Economy
  Amartya Sarkar, Scottish Church College
- Civilizationalism and Nation Building
  Rit Joshi & Dr Shriya Goyal, DIT University
- Interdisciplinary by Design: English Studies as a Bridge Between the Sciences and the Social Sciences
  Aditya Singh, NIT Raipur
- Reimagining Nation-Building in Badal Sircar's *Evam Indrajit*: Addressing Structural Strain and Emphasizing the Role of Humanities in Civic Transformation
  Ayush Ranjan, IIT Roorkee
- India–Sri Lanka Relations: History, Buddhism, and Cultural Diplomacy
  Shreyosi Chaterji, Lady Brabourne College, University of Calcutta

Panel 2: Digitalization, Education and Sustainable Social Practice

Venue: H-205 (Committee Room)

Chair: Dr Shruti Sengupta (Assistant Professor, IIT Roorkee)

Moderator: Govind S.

- From Digitisation to Digitalisation: The Future of Social Work as a Human-Centric Practice in India
  Ved Vriti, University of Delhi
- Remembering the Forgotten: Literary Memory and Digital Visibility in Tiffany D. Jackson's *Monday's Not Coming*
  Vanniar Evelyn, Pandit Deendayal Energy University

- Litscape India: Reconceptualising Humanities and Social Sciences Curricula through an AI-Enabled Digital Ecosystem
  Dr. Shweta Tiwari, Shree Guru Gobind Singh Tricentenary University
- Towards a Sustainable World through a Sustainable Campus: An Ecocritical Enquiry into Digital Carbon Footprints
  Astha Gupta, Chhatrapati Shahu Ji Maharaj University
- Enhancing Social Transformation Through Inclusive Education, Digital Innovation, and Community Participation: A Framework for Sustainable Development
  Dr Anita Yadav, Uttaranchal University

Panel 3: Digital Society: Affect, Media and Changing Social Relations
Venue: H-206
Chair: Prof Pratap Mohanty (Professor, IIT Roorkee)
Moderator: Farhat Bahar

- Caring Through the Screen: A Care-Ethical Reading of Digital Relationships in Nisha Susan's *The Women Who Forgot to Invent Facebook and Other Stories*
  Ishika Gupta, Pandit Deendayal Energy University
- Recontextualising Psychological Terms on Instagram among Gen Z: A Discursive Psychological Analysis
  Jahnvi Thakur, Dev Sanskriti Vishwavidyalaya
- War/Sports and Peace: Media, Rivalry, and Fan Culture in Indian Television Advertisements
  Tufan De, Banaras Hindu University
- The Threshold Problem: How the Definition of "Excessive Gaming" Shapes Its Measured Impact on Self-Esteem, Aggression, and Sleep
  Simranpuneet Kaur, Lovely Professional University
- Reading the Receipt: Digital Advertising as Text in the Discourse of the Pink Tax
  Isha Smriti, IIT Roorkee

Panel 4: Legibility and Power: Institutions, Bodies and Marginalized Lives
Venue: H-207 (Reading Room)
Chair: Dr Neha Arora (Associate Professor, Central University of Rajasthan)
Moderator: Sruthy Prakash

- Ear-Marked: Registration, Legibility, and the Paper Animal in Perumal Murugan's *Poonachi*
  Mrinal Pant, University of Lucknow
- From Care to Control: Lucia State Hospital as a site of power in *Ratched* (2020)
  Somreeta Dinda, National Institute of Technology Warangal

- Illegible Bodies: State Legibility and Narrative Resistance in J.M. Coetzee's *Life & Times of Michael K*
  Akanksha, Lovely Professional University
- Imagining Sustainable Governance: Gender Performativity and Necropolitics in Sheri S. Tepper's *The Gate to Women's Country*
  Sandip Mondal, Adyapeath Annada Polytechnic College
- From Marginalization to Citizenship: Transgender Identities and Social Transformation in Contemporary India
  Dr. Pankaj Kumar Yadav, Graphic Era (Deemed to be University)

Panel 5: Reimagining Space and Sustainability: Literature, Ecology, and Social Worlds in South Asia

Venue: H-301 (Discussion Room-2)

Chair: Prof Vijay Negi (Professor, Graphic Era University)

Moderator: Chitra Kumari

- Beyond the Planned City: Literature, Lived Space, and Sustainable Urban Futures in South Asia
  Afsha Naaz, Jamia Millia Islamia
- Imagining Sustainable Futures through Women's Action-Oriented Climate Praxis: A Global South Voice in Sonali Prasad's *Glass Bottom*
  Priyanka S Raj, Mahindra University
- Preserving the Season: Revaluing Local Food Knowledge in Jharkhand and Uttarakhand for Sustainable Futures
  Swati Mahato, University of Delhi
- The Nation Beneath the Soil: Extractive Nation Building and Ecological Belonging in Amitav Ghosh's *The Nutmeg's Curse*
  Sabyasachi Sahoo, Ravenshaw University
- Friendship Across Social Boundaries: Gendered Spatial Practices of Secularism in Neelum Saran Gour's *Invisible Ink* and Arundhati Roy's *The God of Small Things*
  Shifa Mukhtar, Amity University, Uttar Pradesh

Panel 6: Race, Gender and the Politics of Marginalized Identities

Venue: H-406 (Classroom-1)

Chair: Dr Sonal Jha (Assistant Professor, IIT Roorkee)

Moderator: Stanzin Dolma

- Affect, Power, and the Self/Other Divide: Reading Race, Gender, and National Belonging in Rahul Varma's *Counter Offence*
  Seba Elezabeth Saji, St. Francis de Sales College

- Becoming Whole: Cultural Heritage and the Reimagined Female Bildungsroman in *Beloved* and *The Color Purple*
  Pragya Rawat, Banasthali Vidyapith
- Memory, Silence and Marginalized Histories: Reconstructing the Past in Susan Choi's Fiction
  Priya Dwivedi, Lovely Professional University
- The Voice Behind the Stone: Re-Examining Virtue, Victimhood, and Social Justice in *Ahalya's Awakening*
  Neelima Madhesiya, Madan Madan Malviya University of Technology Gorakhpur
- Essential for Whom? Class, Charity, and Unequal survival in Udayan Mukherjee's *Essential Items*
  Khushi Chauhan, Graphic Era (Deemed to be) University

Panel 7: Gendered Bodies: Care, Motherhood and Biopolitical Power

Venue: H-411 (Classroom-2)

Chair: Dr Aruni Mahapatra (Assistant Professor, IIT Roorkee)

Moderator: Ira Gore

- Emotional Precarity and Commodification: The Impact of Heteronormative Beauty Norms on Breast Cancer Survivors Facing Chemotherapy-Induced Alopecia
  Shreya Saha, Institute of Infrastructure Technology Research and Management
- From Independence to Interdependence: Gender, Illness, and Care in *Queen of Tears*
  Shubhangi Verma, Shri Vaishnav Vidyapeeth Vishwavidyalaya
- Nation-Building through Exclusion: Gendered Trauma and "Bare Life" in Margaret Atwood's *The Handmaid's Tale*
  Falguni Sadhu & Dr. Anu Baisel, VIT Vellore
- Negotiating Care, Selfhood, and Maternal Agency in Anuradha Roy's Fiction
  Sikta Kar, NIT Rourkela
- Insular Geographies and Experimental Separatism in the Speculative Fictions of Padmanabhan and Mackintosh
  Jahnavi Gupta, IIT Roorkee
- Situating 'Body' and Law in Trans Motherhood in India
  Dr Kumari Ruchi, UPES

Panel 8: Gender, Caste, Education and Digital Empowerment

Venue: H-601 (Auditorium)

Chair: Dr Rishmanjot Kaur Chahal (Assistant Professor, IIT Roorkee)

Moderator: Raunak Kumar

- Caste, Cultural Policy, and the Digital Construction of Bharatanatyam's Public Image in Contemporary India
  Pallavi Devi

- From Digital Access to Economic Agency: Re-examining Women's Empowerment in India's Digital Financial Ecosystem
  Bhavya Bhagat, Motherhood University Roorkee
- From Gender Bias to Gender Awareness in Educators: A Non-Binary Approach
  Dr Srishti Kapri, Uttaranchal University
- Gender Equality in Higher Education: A Survey-Based Study of College Students' Perceptions in Jaipur
  Shiv Priya, Swami Keshvanand Institute of Technology, Management & Gramothan
- Mindful Learning for Sustainable Living: Integrating Environmental Ethics into Education
  Nouzia Noordeen, Chinmaya Vishwa Vidyapeeth University

Panel Session II: 04:45 PM to 05:45 PM

Panel 9: Vernacular Worlds: Culture, Region and Collective Identity
Venue: H-201 (Visitor's Lounge)
Chair: Dr Roluahpuia (Associate Professor, IIT Roorkee)
Moderator: Rishav Raj Singh

- A Contemporary Socio-Cultural Study of Hill-stations in Garhwal: Memory, Identity and Co-existence
  Surbhi Payal, Central University of Rajasthan
- Beyond the Frame: Padmavati and Bani-Thani as Cultural Touchstones and Archive of Cultural Sustainability, Agency and Empowerment.
  Himani Sharma
- From Vernacular Voice to Nation-Building: Social Transformation and Environmental Sustainability in the Folksongs of Narendra Singh Negi
  Khushi & Dr. Vijay Negi, Graphic Era (Deemed to be University)
- Voicing the Pahad: Uniyal's Nanda Devi Express and the Emerging Hip-Hop Culture of Uttarakhand
  Angel Chaudhary & Sandhya Parmar, HNB Garhwal University

Panel 10: Rethinking Conservation, Corporate Exploitation, and Ecological Labor
Venue: H-205 (Committee Room)
Chair: Prof Smita Jha (Professor, IIT Roorkee)
Moderator: Harsh Srivastava

- Beyond Anthropocentric Sustainability: The Ethics of Multispecies Coexistence in the Sundarbans
  Jigeesha Dey, Banaras Hindu University

- From Ecological Exploitation to Environmental Justice: The Revival of Sustainability in Imbolo Mbue's *How Beautiful We Were*
  Gayatri Muduli, Ravenshaw University
- The Security–Ecology Trade-Off in Himalayan Road Widening: A Proposed Threshold Framework
  Sarangi Chamoli, Graphic Era (Deemed to be University)
- From the Ground Up: Empowering Front Line Employees through Green HR Practice for Sustainable Transformation
  Kaushik Paul, Maulana Abul Kalam Azad University of Technology

Panel 11: Displacement, Loss, and Literary Environmental Justice
Venue: H-206
Chair: Prof Prabha Lama (Professor, Graphic Era Deemed to be University)
Moderator: Aparna Reghunathan

- Fragile Ecologies: Environmental Injustice, Social Inequality, and Displacement in Contemporary Indian Literature.
  Abinaya. A, Bharathiar University
- Beyond the Royal Victory: Environmental Destruction and Subaltern Grief in *After Kurukshetra*
  Dr. Komal Verma, B.R.A. Bihar University
- Climate Inequality, Displacement and Environmental Justice in Téa Obreht's *The Morningside*
  Kamalpreet Kaur, Lovely Professional University
- Discourse, Displacement and the Politics of Belonging in Amitav Ghosh's *The Hungry Tide*
  Srishti Gusain, Graphic Era (Deemed to be University)

Panel 12: Education, Value Building and the Making of Social Futures
Venue: H-207 (Reading Room)
Chair: Dr Manish Kumar Asthana (Associate Professor, IIT Roorkee)
Moderator: Deepti Bhardwaj

- Bharatanatyam-Inspired Movement for Nurturing Emotional Intelligence in Children: An Indian Knowledge Systems–Based Educational Approach
  Dr. Kavitha Rajan, Chinmaya Vishwa Vidyapeeth Ernakulam
- Fostering Sustainable Nation Building through Educational Psychology: Exploring Learner Motivation, Well-Being, and Value Development in Higher Education
  Mohd Habeeb Khan, MJP Rohilkhand University
- From Impulse to Insight: Emotionally Intelligent Citizens as Architects of India's Journey to Viksit Bharat

Dr Rashmi Gupta & Dr Narendra Kumar, RIT Roorkee & PIET

- Sanskrit Lexicography today – aspect of a multidimensional lexicon
  Deepali Tiwari & Prof Girish Nath, Jawaharlal Nehru University
- AI and Decolonization Movement in Academia: Mapping the Legacy of Tech on Humanities
  Anjani Kumar Rai, University of Delhi

Panel 13: Fostering Strong Voices: Probing Issues in Classroom Communication

Venue: H-301 (Discussion Room-2)

Chair: Dr Lalatendu K Das (Assistant Professor, IIT Roorkee)

Moderator: Gadha Prasannan

- Neuro-Inclusive Pedagogy: Intersecting Neuroscience, Technology, and ELT for Sustainable Nation Building
  Monicka Sre R V, NIT Tiruchirappalli
- From Doubt to Dialogue: Student Experiences of Questioning
  Dr Ammu G Nair & Dr Nita Joseph, Chinmaya Vishwa Vidyapeeth
- Rethinking Age in Second Language Acquisition: From Biological Foundations to Contemporary Perspectives on the Critical Period Hypothesis
  Mannu, Banasthali Vidyapith

Panel 14: Digital Humanities: New Forms of Narrative and Literary Culture

Venue: H-406 (Classroom-1)

Chair: Prof Sanjit Mishra (Professor, IIT Roorkee)

Moderator: Shivangi Patel

- Beyond the Page: Tolkien's *The Lord of the Rings* and the Digital Transformation of Narrative
  Sherin Immaculate A & Vetha S, Bharathiar University
- Circulating the Counter-Discourse: (Re)framing *Karukku* in Digital Publics
  Akshay Kumar, IIT Roorkee
- Derived Dystopia: Cultural Replacement in Dave Eggers' *The Circle*
  Shivansh Mishra, Central University of Rajasthan
- From Oral Memory to Algorithmic Memory: Digital Platforms and the Intergenerational Transmission of Cultural Knowledge in Uttarakhand
  Shivani Panday, Graphic Era University

Panel 15: Narratology within Digital Humanities and Algorithmic Computation

Venue: H-411 (Classroom-2)

Chair: Dr Goldy Yadav (Assistant Professor, IIT Roorkee)

Moderator: Ankita Pandey

- Mediating the Sacred and the Profane: The Affective Politics of Green Nation-building and Sustainability
  Sakshi Kumari, EFLU Lucknow
- Reinventing Narrativity under Digital Humanities: An Inquiry into Transmedial Narratology and Theorization from Print to Electronic Literature.
  Jaishree Chouhan, ICFAI University
- Maithili Translation & Study of "Mṛcchakaṭikam" in the Context of AI Integration and Cultural Adaptation
  Priyanka Raj, Jawaharlal Nehru University
- Preserving the Civilisational Memory of the *Ramayana*: A Study in the Context of Digital Humanities
  Shashank Tiwari and Prof. Girish Nath Jha, Jawaharlal Nehru University

Panel 16: AI and the Posthuman: Technology, Power and Algorithmic Life

Venue: H-601 (Auditorium)

Chair: Prof Nagendra Kumar (Professor, IIT Roorkee)

Moderator: Labanya Dey

- From Silicon to Soil: Artificial Intelligence and Neuro-Technologies as Enablers of Ecological Empathy in Richard Powers' *Bewilderment* (2021)
  Surbhi, Lovely Professional University
- Recoding Discrimination: Posthuman Bias and Caste in Contemporary South Asian Speculative Fiction
  Ashank Chaudhary, Graphic Era (Deemed to be University)
- Suspended Agency: Algorithmic Governance and Moral Displacement in *Wrong Way*
  Balavaishnavi B, Bharathiar University
- Computational Narratology: How AI Reshapes Narrative Structures and Reader Participation
  Dr. Abrity Thakur, ABES Engineering College

Day 2: 10.10.2026

TIME	PARTICULARS	VENUE
08:00 AM - 09:00 AM	*Breakfast*	Khosla International House (KIH)
09:00 AM - 10:00 AM	Registration of Participants	1st Floor HSS Department
10:00 AM - 10:45 AM	Plenary Lecture - IV **Prof Bindu Puri** **Jawaharlal Nehru University**	Auditorium (H-601) HSS Department
10:45 AM - 11:00 AM	Address by the Sanako Representative	
11:00 AM - 11:30 AM	*High Tea*	6th Floor HSS Department
11:30 AM - 01:00 PM	Panel Session - III	
01:00 PM - 02:15 PM	*Lunch*	Khosla International House (KIH)
02:15 PM - 03:00 PM	Plenary Session - V **Prof H Kalpana Rao** **Pondicherry University**	Auditorium (H-601) HSS Department
03:00 PM - 03:15 PM	Address by the JSTOR Representative	
03:15 PM - 03:45 PM	*Tea Break*	6th Floor HSS Department
03:45 PM - 04:15 PM	Plenary Lecture - VI **Dr Elizabeth Chloe Romanis** **Durham Law School**	Auditorium (H-601) HSS Department
04:15 PM - 05:15 PM	Valedictory Session	

Panel Session III: 11:30 AM to 01:00 PM

Panel 17: Archives, Displacement and the Politics of Cultural Memory

Venue: H-201 (Visitor's Lounge)

Chair: Dr Shweta Tiwari (Assistant Professor, Shree Guru Gobind Singh Tricentenary University)

Moderator: Sakshi Kashyap

- Deconstructing Colonial Discourse: Sustainable Historiography and the 1921 Malabar Rebellion
  Sana Sulaikha M, University of Calicut
- Echoes of the Displaced: Subverting State Narratives and Constructing Identity in Zana Farallon's *The Bone Sparrow* (2016) and Sulaiman Addonia's Silence *Is My Mother Tongue* (2019)
  Divya Hazra, IIITDM Jabalpur
- What the Archive Did Not Keep: Testimony, Fabulation, and the Memory of Indenture
  Shambhaviee Upadhyay, University of Delhi
- Who Gets Archived? Digitalization, Linguistic Inequity, and the Making of National Memory
  Mani Kumdesh, GNIOT
- Counter-Archiving the Nation: An exploration of Digital Feminist Zines as Third Spaces for South Asian Feminist Discourse
  Debapriya Sarkar, IIT Roorkee

Panel 18: Affect, Trauma and the Narrative Experience of Loss

Venue: H-205 (Committee Room)

Chair: Dr Shiv Priya (Assistant Professor, Swami Keshvanand Institute of Technology, Management and Gramothan)

Moderator: Pranav Bhushan

- From Isolation to Belonging: Constructing Identity and Community in Jacqueline Harpman's *I Who Have Never Known Men*
  Shubhangi Rawat, HNB Garhwal University
- The Brain, the Body, and the Narrative Self: A Neurocognitive Approach to Trauma, Memory, and Identity Reconstruction in Ocean Vuong's *On Earth We're Briefly Gorgeous* (2019)
  Dr. Vickey Prasad, Lovely Professional University
- The Multiple Dimensions of Loss: A Critical Analysis of Gender and Emotion in Chimamanda Adichie's *Notes on Grief* and C.S. Lewis's *A Grief Observed*
  Arpita Singh, IIT Roorkee

- The Psychology of "What if"-Counterfactual theory in the *Midnight Library*(2020)
  Preeti Sharma, Uttaranchal University
- "This is the same for every family!": Hostile Household, and the Refusal of Clinical Containment in *Bhoothakaalam* (2022)
  Govind S, IIT Roorkee

Panel 19: Agency, Labour and Behavioural Change for Sustainable Futures
Venue: H-206
Chair: Dr Ammu G Nair (Assistant Professor, Chinmaya Vishwa Vidyapeeth University)
Moderator: Ayushi Dash

- Beyond Dependency: Weaver Agency and Coping Strategies in the Banarasi Handloom Saree Industry
  Sachin Seth, University of Delhi
- From Servant Leadership to Sustainable HRM: Examining the Mediating Role of Employee Empowerment and Engagement
  Shaifali & Ashish Kumar, SRM Institute of Science and Technology & Institute for Education and Technical-sciences, Muradnagar
- Rethinking Sustainable Nation-Building through Behavioural and Cultural Changes
  Priyanka Singh, Banasthali Vidyapith
- Decision-Making in the Face of Uncertainty: Exploring Psychological Hardiness and Intolerance of Uncertainty
  Aishwarya Rathore, Graphic Era (Deemed to be University)

Panel 20: Interdisciplinary Approaches to Nation-Building
Venue: H-207 (Reading Room)
Chair: Dr Anita Yadav (Assistant Professor, Uttaranchal University)
Moderator: Swastika Roy

- Translating Environmental Justice: Bio-semiotics, Policy, and Governance in Nation-Building
  Anushka Pauranik, IIT Mandi
- Role of Humanities and Social Sciences in Nation Building
  Dr. Rashmi Kaushik, Swami Keshavanad Institute of Technology, Management and Gramothan
- Reimagining Corporate Governance in Viksit Bharat: Lessons from Kautilya's *Arthashastra* for ESG, Accountability and Responsible Capitalism
  Anand Sooraj, Bhavans PALSAR
- Between the Radio and the Road: A Critical Discourse Analysis of Development and Nation-Building in *Fire in the Mountains*
  Aditi Rana, University of Delhi

- ESG Disclosure and Firm Financial Performance: Evidence from Emerging Market Firms
  Sakshi Gupta, Graphic Era (Deemed to be) University

Panel 21: Ecological Belonging and Literary Landscapes

Venue: H-301 (Discussion Room-2)

Chair: Dr Nita Joseph (Assistant Professor, Chinmaya Vishwa Vidyapeeth)

Moderator: Gowri S

- Flowing Identity: Rivers and the Transformation of Karna in the *Mahabharata*
  Aparna & Dr. Vijay Negi, Graphic Era (Deemed to be University)
- Sprung Grief: Solastalgia and the Ecological Body in the Poetry of Gerard Manley Hopkins
  Prasanna Kumar, University of Delhi
- Who Owns the Grassland? Ecological Citizenship, Environmental Justice and the Politics of Belonging in Jiang Rong's *Wolf Totem*
  Dr. Yogeshwar Dwivedi, Government Engineering College West Champaran
- Uneven Vulnerabilities on the Coast: Reading Environmental Injustice through Odia Cinema
  Anwesha Panda,
- Digging for the Ganga: Water Scarcity and Environmental Justice in Sarnath Banerjee's *All Quiet in Vikaspuri*
  Blessy Rachel.D, Bharathiar University

Panel 22: Between Healing and Medical Power: A Discourse on Cure and Control

Venue: H-406 (Classroom-1)

Chair: Dr Shreyansh Jain (Assistant Professor, Christ (Deemed to be) University, Delhi NCR)

Moderator: Suyasha Singh

- Becoming Bare Life: Biopolitical Control, Cure and Collapse in David B.'s *Epileptic*
  Ruma Singh, IIT Roorkee
- Traditional Medicine and Healing Practices in the Dhodia Tribe
  Patel Khushi Miteshbhai, Saurashtra University
- Body, Self, and Mental Health: Probing Minority Stress in *I Am Vidya*
  Shikha Soni, University of Rajasthan

Panel 23: Writing Against the Grain: Gender, Identity, and Resistance in Contemporary Narratives

Venue: H-411 (Classroom-2)

Chair: Dr Nancy Sharma (Assistant Professor, NIT Agartala)

Moderator: Tulsi Sharma

- Negotiating Culture, Sustainability, and Female Resistance in Contemporary Indian Women's Fiction
  Shobha Gautam & Dr. Antima Chamoli, Graphic Era (Deemed to be) University

- Writing the Self, Contesting the Nation: Transgender Autobiography as Counter-Discourse to Hegemonic National Identity in India
  Kanika Pokhriyal, Graphic Era (Deemed to be) University
- Visualising Trans Graphic Medicine: Gender, Gatekeeping, and Gazing in Emma Grove's *The Third Person*
  Sveta Raman, IIT Roorkee
- Her Story, Her Power: Reclaiming Female Agency in *Bulbbul* and *Stree* through Intersectional Feminist Perspectives
  Ibadat Bedi, Christ (Deemed to be) University, Delhi NCR
- Understanding Queer Identity Formation Through Sex Education: A Psychological Analysis
  Gitesh Nanda & Anushka Singh, Christ (Deemed to be) University, Delhi NCR

Panel 24: Interdisciplinary Inquiries into Health and Illness

Venue: H-601 (Auditorium)

Chair: Dr Srishti Kapri (Assistant Professor, Uttaranchal University)

Moderator: Kasturi Lal

- Maternal Prenatal Emotional Experience and Child Neurodevelopmental Difficulties: A Retrospective Case Study
  Dr Prateek Chauhan, Jigyasa University
- Narrating Health and Illness: Literature as a Tool for Social Transformation
  Pavithra M, Presidency College, Chennai
- From *Manichitrathazhu* to *Bhool Bhulaiyaa*: Bollywoodisation and the Representation of Mental Illness in Indian Cinema
  Elizabeth Richard, Christ (Deemed to be) University, Delhi NCR